

POINT OF VIEW • 2026

Closing the *execution* gap.

A point of view for chief executives on execution certainty and the Transformation Management Office.



THE ARGUMENT

The plan was never the *problem*.

Why execution certainty, not another strategy refresh, is the scarce asset on the GCC board agenda.

GCC boards do not lack strategy. They lack delivery certainty. The region's financial institutions have commissioned more strategy in the past five years than in the previous twenty. The vision documents are strong. The capital is available. The gap opens after approval, when a hundred initiatives meet one operating reality and no single owner is accountable for the whole.

Programme reporting is not governance. Status decks record what happened. They do not force decisions. When a newly merged capital markets institution committed to a Top 5 position in Saudi Arabia by 2027, the constraint was not ambition. It was visibility: knowing which initiatives were truly on track, and who would act when they were not.

A Transformation Management Office changes the physics. The TMO sits above the programmes and below the Board. It holds a single source of truth for execution and risk, forces trade-offs at a fixed cadence, and stays until the result lands. Strategy stops being a document. It becomes a managed asset with committed dates and named owners.

“Strategy survives contact with reality because we *never leave the room*.”

THE FRAMEWORK

Three shifts that close the *gap*.

01

From reporting to one source of truth

The TMO establishes the target operating model as the single source of truth, giving the CEO and Board full visibility into execution and risk.

02

From tracking to decision-forcing governance

Reporting records; governance decides. A fixed cadence puts every stalled initiative in front of the executive who can unblock it, with dates owned at Board level.

03

From handover to capability that stays

Practitioners who have held the roles they advise on work inside the institution's teams, so delivery discipline remains after the engagement ends.

CASE STUDY

Top 5

MARKET POSITIONING IN KSA

TMO-led strategic execution, Saudi capital markets

A newly merged capital markets institution

THE CHALLENGE

A commitment to reach the Top 5 in KSA by 2027, with Board dates attached to six key initiatives and no shared view of delivery across the merged organisation.

WHAT WE DID

Stood up a Transformation Management Office with rigorous governance and full executive visibility, running execution as a single portfolio with named owners.

THE OUTCOME

Six key initiatives delivered ahead of Board committed dates, with the institution positioned for Top 5 in KSA by 2027.

Top 5
Market positioning in KSA

6
Key initiatives ahead of Board dates

2027
Board committed horizon

Four moves the CEO can *own*.

01

Appoint one owner

Stand up a TMO that reports to the CEO, not to the programmes it governs.

02

Publish one truth

A single execution and risk view, shared with the Board. Retire every parallel status deck.

03

Fix the cadence

A decision-forcing forum with dates owned at Board level. Escalation is a duty, not a failure.

04

Keep the muscle

Contract for capability transfer so delivery discipline outlasts the engagement.

Leading with clarity.
Delivering the *difference*.

Start a conversation

ABOUT ASPIRO

Aspiro is an independent, investor-free management consultancy for GCC financial institutions, founded in Dubai in 2015 with offices in Riyadh and London. Its partners carry 100+ years of senior leadership experience, backed by a network of 8,000+ specialists.

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